

Public service jobs that qualify under the College Cost Reduction and Access Act include teachers, librarians, child care workers, social workers, government workers, military service, police and fire workers, public interest legal services, and public health workers. For more info, see <http://www.finaid.org/loans/publicservice.phtml>.

Class Dismissed

Before we tackle the other topics at hand, I have another *Debt Cures* piece of advice for you. College is expensive. Outrageously expensive and I see no end in sight. There is a great and smart way to get an education from a top school and not pay top dollar.

Let's assume you were accepted to UCLA or some other big name national university. You can defer your acceptance for two years, and make sure you get it in writing. For the first two years, go to your local city college and take all the basic required classes. Most of the time, the core classes are the same and sometimes the textbooks are even the same. You'll pay \$100 a semester as opposed to \$10,000 a semester. Living at home can save you a bundle as well, plus there are meals and laundry facilities right there.

You have the deal in writing and after two years, you transfer all your credits to UCLA. You complete the second half of your education in your major and get your degree from a top notch school. The prestige of the UCLA degree is yours. You got the same education as if you would have attended all four years there, and you paid half the price.

Now that is smart.